

5.10.2 Content Filters

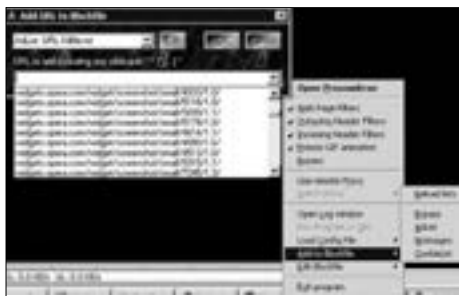
In the normal course of browsing, clicking a link causes a request to be sent to the Web server. The Web server sends the relevant data to the browser. Depending on the page, additional requests will be automatically generated and sent to many other Web sites, like ad servers, for content. Additionally, a browser offers information regarding the user's IP, the Web page previously visited (or referrer), the OS being used, the browser agent, etc. to a Web server, which is (or can be) used to tailor the content sent to the user.

Content Filters act as an intermediary between the browser and the Web server. Depending on the user specification, the application can—in real time—filter the requests sent by the browser to the Web server, thus preventing unwanted Web sites inserting data into what is sent to the user's PC. Content Filters can also prevent the leakage of system information by the browser from the user's system.

5.10.2.1 Proxomitron

This is a content-filtering proxy. Once installed, the browser's connection settings need to be modified to use the proxy. By default, this is IP 127.0.0.1 and port 8080.

Some of Proxomitron's capabilities include blocking of ads; blocking of images; blocking of Web sites; modification or blocking of header information related to the OS, browsing agent, referrer, or cookies; modifying or blocking scripts related to pop-ups, frames, sounds in Web pages, scrolling text, window resizing, preventing right-clicks; and more.



Adding a URL to the Proxomitron blocked list

Proxomitron comes pre-loaded with a huge list of sites that have a history of sending spyware, so the user is freed from the considerable labour of adding each one to the browser's blocked